DYNAMIC TENSION

Dynamic tension is a way of using the energy and movement available in various features of the frame to draw the eye out of the picture. This happens in contrasting directions, or due to contrasting colors.

Converging Lines/Strong Focal Point

Converging lines bring you to the center of the frame where the lines meet. You are led out by other converging lines.

Leading Lines

When you combine multiple leading lines that lead to the same subject, you can cause dynamic tension. Rather than one clear path for your eyes to follow, they are exploring multiple routes.

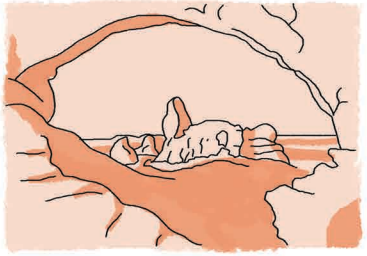
Contrasting Lines

Lines with no clear direction, and no single converging point of interest, can provide the strongest dynamic tension.

FRAMING

A frame within a frame emphasizes the importance of the subject. The viewer's eyes are drawn to it instinctively.

Natural Elements

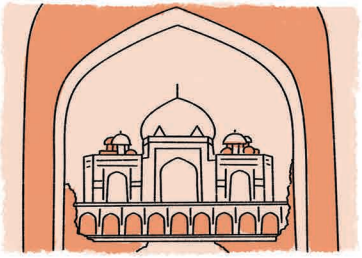


Use arches as a natural frame for similar objects for continuity.

Trees are a perfect frame for urban areas. They add juxtaposition to your scenes.

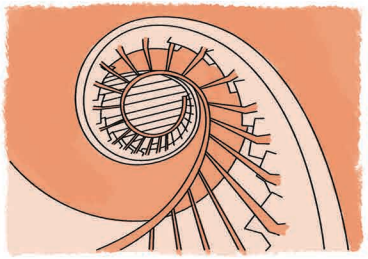
Architectural Elements

Repeated designs are a great way to lead the viewer's eyes toward an off-center subject.



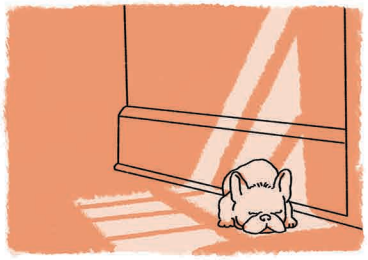
Use arches as natural frames for similar objects. This creates continuity.

Geometric Shapes



Stairwells are a great way to lead a viewer's eyes into the center of the frame.

Using Light/Shadow



Light acts as a frame in a dark room. It illuminates the subject it touches.